



boxers are assessed on several factors and put through an evaluation process over a few weeks, has given rise to a constant rivalry between some world-class boxers, including those who have switched to newer weights to stake their claim for the Olympics.

Amit Panghal, a former Worlds silver medallist, recently secured the gold medal at the National Championships, making a notable comeback. He aims to challenge Deepak in the 51kg category. In the 57kg category, Sachin Siwach poses a potential challenge for Hussamuddin, while the 71kg division may witness intriguing bouts between the talented national champion Akash Sangwan and Nishant. Established boxers like Shiva Thapa (63.5kg), a former Worlds medallist and two-time Olympian, and Sanjeet (92kg), a former Asian champion, also have the prospect of qualifying for the Paris Games.

The coaching staff is still sweating

Racing against time: Mohammad Hussamuddin's (57kg) left knee injury at the World Championships was a big setback. Indian boxing lovers would hope for his timely recovery ahead of Paris 2024. IBA

over the limited options in the 80kg weight class, which includes Olympian Ashish Kumar and national champion Lakshya Chahar. Chahar is currently nursing an injury.

It would be interesting to see if anyone can challenge Narender in +92kg, especially after Olympian Satish Kumar was beaten in the national championships in Shillong and Commonwealth Games silver medallist Sagar Ahlawat was knocked out (KO) in the final at the Meghalaya capital last month.

In the event of a KO or Referee Stops Contest (RSC), the ringside doctor is required to complete and sign a medical bout report. This report is then submitted to the Technical Delegate along with the



Highlights of 2023

Indian women boxers had one of the finest performances in the World Championships, winning four gold medals. Nikhat Zareen (**50kg**) won a second successive gold, while Lovlina Borgohain (**75kg**), Saweety Boora (**81kg**) and Nitu Ghangas (**48kg**) claimed their maiden World titles

Indian women bagged four medals — Lovlina (**silver, 75kg**), Nikhat (**bronze, 50kg**), Preeti Pawar (**bronze, 54kg**) and Parveen Hooda (**bronze, 57kg**) — and secured as many Olympic quota places in the Hangzhou Asian Games

Indian men won three bronze medals in the World Championships. Deepak Bhorla (**51kg**), Mohammad Hussamuddin (**57kg**) and Nishant Dev (**71kg**) cornered glory **Narender Berwal (bronze, +92kg)** was the lone Indian male to medal at the Asian Games